

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES

*One operating standard for the full rental day.
Authority defined. Risk classified. Actions documented.*

CONTROLLED DOCUMENT

CLASSIFICATION	CONFIDENTIAL INTERNAL OPERATING MANUAL - AUTHORIZED OPERATORS ONLY
EDITION	01 / SEPTEMBER 2026
APPLICATION	RENTAL OPERATIONS - COUNTER, FIELD, SUPERVISION, OWNER
AUTHORITY	OWNER / OPERATING AUTHORITY
NEXT REVIEW	SEPTEMBER 2027 OR EARLIER AFTER MATERIAL CHANGE

01

Purpose and limits

What this standard governs - and what remains outside it.

WHAT THIS STANDARD GOVERNS

This standard governs the sequence, authority, communication, escalation, and records used to operate a rental day from opening through closing. It covers counter activity, field response, customer return, risk classification, law-enforcement escalation, mechanical interruption, operational charges, records, training gates, and controlled deviations.

WHAT THIS STANDARD DOES NOT REPLACE

REFERENCE	THIS STANDARD DOES NOT REPLACE
Agreement / Customer Execution Packet	Customer terms, acknowledgments, signatures, disclosures, and payment authorization.
Pickup & Return	Condition inspection, asset handoff, return inspection, and linked inspection record.
Fleet Standard	Maintenance, service intervals, repair decisions, and asset readiness systems.
Local Rules	Jurisdiction-specific operating rules and guest-facing restrictions.
Employee Training Guide	Role instruction, onboarding, and the employee acknowledgment maintained in the employee file.
Office Operations Standard	Document retention, office security, systems, keys, records, and facility controls.
Insurance / counsel / emergency services	Insurer direction, qualified legal advice, local law, 911, or official emergency instructions.

OPERATING PRINCIPLES

- Safety overrides the rental.
- The written procedure overrides improvisation.
- Confirm the asset and the active rental before enforcement.
- Document immediately.
- Escalate by classification, not by mood.
- Staff do not chase, touch, argue, post, or admit fault on behalf of the company.

OPERATING BOUNDARY

When law, emergency direction, insurer requirements, or owner-approved written policy imposes a stricter rule, the stricter control governs. This standard does not authorize conduct that is unlawful, unsafe, or beyond the employee's assigned authority.

02

Roles and authority

Every action has an owner. Authority is not assumed.

ROLE	MAY DO	MAY NOT DO
Counter	Build the file; verify eligibility; pause or refuse release when a written pre-release requirement is not met; explain approved policy; issue routine administrative notices; call a supervisor.	Invent terms or charges; decide fault; authorize a replacement asset; alter signed terms; pursue a customer; represent legal or insurance conclusions.
Field	Confirm the asset and rental; observe; contact the renter; direct an immediate safety correction; disengage when unsafe; preserve evidence; request supervision or emergency assistance.	Chase, touch, block, physically recover in an unsafe setting, argue fault, apply a new charge, or promise a replacement.
Supervisor / manager	Resolve escalations; confirm termination of an active rental; authorize replacement when delegated; review disputed charges; direct incident response; speak with hostile customers; make non-emergency law-enforcement contact.	Override law, insurer requirements, owner controls, or signed customer terms; classify negligence without evidence.
Owner	Set and approve operating authority; approve controlled procedures and deviations; authorize final charge/fault decisions; decide unresolved replacements, terminations, claims, and serious incident closure.	Delegate away emergency obligations or authorize unsafe / unlawful conduct.

EMERGENCY AUTHORITY

Any employee may call 911 without prior approval when there is an injury, immediate threat, violence, active dangerous driving, or another urgent danger to a person or the public. Internal hierarchy never delays an emergency call.

Authority may be expanded only by written owner delegation. Verbal habit, seniority, or "how we usually do it" does not create authority.

03

Authority map and operating documents

One table for decision rights. One table for the records that support the day.

DECISION AUTHORITY

ACTION	COUNTER	FIELD	SUPERVISOR	OWNER
Refuse release before handoff	Yes - written eligibility failure	No	Yes	Yes
Issue routine warning	Yes - administrative	Yes - safety correction	Yes	Yes
Terminate active rental	No	Stop / disengage; communicate only if delegated	Yes	Yes
Authorize replacement asset	No	No	Yes - if delegated	Yes
Apply disclosed routine charge	Process only with required evidence	No	Review / approve per policy	Final authority
Call 911	Yes - emergency	Yes - emergency	Yes	Yes
Call non-emergency law enforcement	Escalate unless written authority	Escalate unless written authority	Yes	Yes
Lead hostile-customer resolution	Pause and escalate	Disengage and escalate	Yes	Yes
Close serious incident	No	No	Recommend after record review	Yes / delegated

DOCUMENTS USED IN THE PROCEDURE

DOCUMENT	WHEN USED
Agreement / Customer Execution Packet	At reservation, release, return, and any customer-term or charge reference.
Pickup & Return	At asset inspection, key handoff, return inspection, asset change, and condition documentation.
Agreement Control Register	To confirm approved ages, required documents, operating boundaries, disclosed charges, and operating decisions.
Local Rules	Provided or explained to the guest before release when applicable.
Incident Record	Created for an incident, high-risk event, material damage, police contact, or management-directed investigation.
Employee Acknowledgment	Signed before field assignment and retained in the employee file; not reproduced in this SOP.

No copy of these supporting documents is embedded in this standard. The current controlled version of each document governs its own function.

04

Opening readiness

Declare the operation ready before the first guest is served.

PROCEDURE CONTROL

PURPOSE	OWNER	WHEN
Confirm that the location, systems, records, keys, and first available asset are ready for controlled operation.	Opening lead / assigned supervisor	Before public opening and before the first release.

STEPS IN ORDER	
01	Secure authorized access to the premises. Walk the customer area and back office for hazards, disorder, confidential material, or unresolved closing issues.
02	Bring reservation, payment, communication, and approved monitoring systems online. Confirm access using authorized individual credentials.
03	Count keys against the current key control record. Resolve any discrepancy before release activity begins.
04	Confirm that at least one asset shown as available is actually release-ready under the Fleet Standard and Pickup & Return process.
05	Verify current customer-facing hours, rates, rules, emergency contacts, and approved operating information are available to staff.
06	Review open incidents, customers still outstanding from the prior period, down units, manager messages, and owner instructions.
07	Declare the location open only when essential controls are functioning or a supervisor has approved a documented contingency.

CONTROL POINT
Opening is an operating decision, not simply a time on the clock. A date or posted hour does not override a failed safety or control gate.

RECORD CREATED	IF THIS FAILS / ESCALATE TO
Opening readiness evidence maintained under the Office Operations Standard; any exception is named in the shift record.	Supervisor immediately. Hold releases when an essential safety, payment, reservation, key, or asset-readiness control is unavailable.

05

Phone and reception

Every guest receives one calm, consistent operating voice.

PROCEDURE CONTROL

PURPOSE	OWNER	WHEN
Give accurate information, protect private information, and route anything outside staff authority to the correct decision-maker.	Counter / reception	Every inbound call, walk-in interaction, complaint, or service request.

STEPS IN ORDER

- 01 Identify the business first, then give your name and ask how you may assist.
- 02 Listen through the customer's first explanation before responding. Clarify the reservation or asset only as needed.
- 03 Use the written agreement, approved rates, rules, and current policy. Do not improvise prices, refunds, exceptions, or enforcement terms.
- 04 For a complaint, acknowledge the concern without agreeing to fault. Review the controlling record before giving an answer.
- 05 If the requested decision exceeds your authority, state that a supervisor will review it and route the matter without debate.
- 06 Protect customer, payment, employee, and incident information from public discussion or casual disclosure.

PROFESSIONAL RESPONSE MODEL

"[Company Name], this is [Name]. How may I help?"

"I understand your concern. Let me review the applicable agreement and operating record so I can give you the correct answer. If this requires authority beyond my role, I will involve the supervisor."

RECORD CREATED	IF THIS FAILS / ESCALATE TO
Reservation note or service note when the contact changes, documents, escalates, or materially affects the rental.	Supervisor for policy disputes, refund demands, hostile behavior, threats, or any issue requiring authority beyond the counter role.

06

Reservation and file assembly

The file is complete before the key leaves control.

PROCEDURE CONTROL

PURPOSE	OWNER	WHEN
Create one accurate reservation record and assemble the company file and guest copy required for release.	Counter	For every reservation, whether booked in advance or created at the counter.

STEPS IN ORDER

- 01 Create or open the reservation and confirm the correct renter, rental period, equipment type, rate, and current contact information.
- 02 Verify required identity and insurance evidence according to the Agreement Control Register. Record only information the business is authorized to retain.
- 03 Present the current Agreement / Customer Execution Packet and obtain required acknowledgments and signatures before release.
- 04 Link the Pickup & Return inspection reference to the reservation. Do not reproduce the inspection inside this SOP.
- 05 Assemble the house file: reservation record, signed agreement, required identity/insurance evidence, linked inspection, and any required operating-rule record.
- 06 Prepare the guest copy: customer-facing agreement/receipt and the approved local rules, map, or operating restrictions the business provides.
- 07 Confirm that the house file is complete enough to identify the renter, asset, terms, and inspection before the key is released.

RECORD CREATED	IF THIS FAILS / ESCALATE TO
Customer / reservation file with current execution packet and linked Pickup & Return inspection reference.	Eligibility procedure if a requirement is missing. Supervisor if a document is disputed, cannot be verified, or the requested exception is outside written policy.

07

Eligibility and refusal

Release only when the person and transaction satisfy the written gate.

PROCEDURE CONTROL

PURPOSE	OWNER	WHEN
Verify objective eligibility and give a controlled refusal when a required condition is not satisfied.	Counter; supervisor for disputed or non-routine refusal	Before signatures are finalized and before key handoff.

STEPS IN ORDER	
01	Confirm the minimum age and driver/participant requirements listed in the Agreement Control Register.
02	Verify the required licence, identification, payment method, and insurance evidence, when the business requires them.
03	Confirm the selected asset capacity and the number of intended occupants or participants.
04	Observe whether the person appears capable of a safe, lawful release. Do not diagnose impairment; act on observable safety concerns and written policy.
05	Refuse release when a required eligibility item is missing, documents are refused, capacity cannot be met, a person is visibly unsafe to operate, or the transaction cannot be completed under the approved agreement.
06	State the refusal in neutral policy language. Do not argue the reason in the street or attempt to prove wrongdoing.
07	Record the objective control that prevented release and escalate any disputed refusal to the supervisor.

PROFESSIONAL RESPONSE MODEL

"I am not able to release the rental because a required release condition has not been satisfied. I can have the supervisor review the record with you."

CONTROL POINT

Refusal is based on a written eligibility or safety control - not on mood, assumption, appearance unrelated to safety, or an improvised rule.

RECORD CREATED	IF THIS FAILS / ESCALATE TO
Reservation note stating the control not satisfied, time, employee, and supervisor involvement if any.	Supervisor for dispute or uncertainty. 911 when the situation becomes an immediate safety threat or involves violence.

08

Release sequence

Inspection, rules, signatures, then key.

PROCEDURE CONTROL

PURPOSE	OWNER	WHEN
Transfer the asset only after the transaction, inspection, operating boundaries, and signatures are complete.	Counter + assigned release operator	Immediately before the renter takes control of the asset.

STEPS IN ORDER

- 01 Confirm the reservation file and eligibility gate are complete.
- 02 Perform the pre-rental inspection using the current Pickup & Return document. This SOP states when and by whom; the inspection itself remains in that document.
- 03 Explain the controls the guest must know before departure: authorized area, restricted locations, hours, return time, late-return rule, capacity, and current local rules.
- 04 Demonstrate essential safe operation appropriate to the equipment and answer operational questions without changing the written terms.
- 05 Obtain all required signatures and acknowledgments. Confirm the guest received or can access the customer copy and rules.
- 06 Match the key or asset identifier to the reservation.
- 07 Release the key only after the file, inspection, and signatures are complete.

CONTROL POINT

The key is the final control point. Friendly departure language never substitutes for a completed release sequence.

RECORD CREATED	IF THIS FAILS / ESCALATE TO
Signed Customer Execution Packet + linked Pickup & Return inspection + key / asset association in the customer file.	Hold the release and return to eligibility or reservation assembly if any required control is incomplete. Supervisor for exceptions.

09

During-rental control

Observe deliberately. Intervene only through the approved response path.

PROCEDURE CONTROL

PURPOSE	OWNER	WHEN
Define what staff may monitor, when contact is justified, and how an observation becomes a controlled record.	Counter, field, or supervisor according to assigned monitoring role	From release until return or formal termination.

STEPS IN ORDER

- 01 Use only authorized information sources: customer contact, staff observation, approved GPS/telematics, system status, or credible witness information.
- 02 Do not continuously monitor for reasons unrelated to safety, operational control, recovery, or another approved purpose.
- 03 When a concern is observed, first identify the asset and confirm an active rental before enforcement.
- 04 Classify the situation Low, Medium, or High before deciding the response path.
- 05 Contact the renter only when the condition requires correction, clarification, assistance, return, or escalation.
- 06 Record a material observation before memory becomes the only evidence: time, location, asset, source, and action taken.
- 07 Do not pursue, confront, or physically intervene in an unsafe off-site situation.

RECORD CREATED	IF THIS FAILS / ESCALATE TO
Routine observation note in the customer file or Incident Record when the event meets incident criteria.	Risk classification matrix, then supervisor / owner / law enforcement according to classification and immediacy.

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Return sequence

Close the asset and the transaction with evidence, not assumption.

PROCEDURE CONTROL

PURPOSE	OWNER	WHEN
Confirm return time, condition, key, accessories, and any documented exception before the rental file is closed.	Counter + assigned return operator	At physical return, recovery, or an approved remote return process.

STEPS IN ORDER

- 01
- Record actual return time and confirm the returning asset matches the reservation.
- 02
- Recover and account for the assigned key and listed accessories.
- 03
- Perform the post-rental inspection on the Pickup & Return document. Compare against the pre-rental condition record.
- 04
- Photograph a material difference, missing item, or damage when documentation is appropriate and permitted.
- 05
- Obtain the required return acknowledgment or signature under the Pickup & Return process.
- 06
- Apply or refer charges only when they were disclosed in the approved agreement and are supported by the required record.
- 07
- Update asset status. Do not return a questionable unit to available status before the Fleet Standard clears it.
- 08
- Prepare the file and asset for the next controlled step: close, incident review, damage review, service, or next rental.

RECORD CREATED	IF THIS FAILS / ESCALATE TO
Completed return section of Pickup & Return; customer file; incident or damage record when required.	Supervisor for disputed charge, condition difference, unresolved damage, missing asset/key, unsafe return, or customer hostility.

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Closing the day

Nothing important is left as an unnamed problem for tomorrow.

PROCEDURE CONTROL

PURPOSE	OWNER	WHEN
Secure keys, files, transactions, open incidents, down assets, and premises before the shift is closed.	Closing lead / supervisor	At the end of public operation and before the last authorized person leaves.

STEPS IN ORDER	
01	Count all keys and compare the expected count with the actual count. Name every exception.
02	Confirm daily transactions, unresolved payment items, and open customer matters are identified for follow-up.
03	File completed customer records and route incident records to the correct controlled location.
04	Identify every asset that is down, held, damaged, missing, or awaiting management review. Ensure its status is consistent across records.
05	Confirm confidential documents, payment devices, credentials, and restricted supplies are secured.
06	Review customers still outside, overdue assets, open incidents, and supervisor/owner actions that remain outstanding.
07	Secure the premises under the Office Operations Standard. No unresolved material issue is left as "we will see tomorrow" without an assigned owner.

RECORD CREATED	IF THIS FAILS / ESCALATE TO
Closing evidence / key count / open-item handoff under the Office Operations Standard.	Owner for unresolved missing keys/assets, open high-risk incident, unresolved customer outside operating hours, failed security control, or material transaction discrepancy.

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Shift handoff

Transfer control, not stories.

PROCEDURE CONTROL

PURPOSE	OWNER	WHEN
Give the incoming team the exact information needed to operate safely without restarting the investigation.	Outgoing shift lead	Whenever responsibility transfers between teams or leaders.

STEPS IN ORDER	
01	State the key count and any key not physically present.
02	Identify assets that are down, held, replaced, recovered, or awaiting inspection.
03	Name every customer still outside, overdue rental, or active service call.
04	Transfer open incidents by reference number or file, not by rumor or casual narrative.
05	Deliver manager/owner instructions and any time-sensitive customer commitments.
06	Confirm the incoming lead accepts the handoff and knows what must occur next.

RECORD CREATED	IF THIS FAILS / ESCALATE TO
Shift handoff note or controlled operating log as established by the Office Operations Standard.	Supervisor / owner when a material issue cannot be clearly transferred, the record is incomplete, or immediate action is still required.

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Risk classification

Classify first. Then act at the level the condition requires.

OPERATING MATRIX

CLASS	CONDITION	IMMEDIATE ACTION	WHO IS CALLED	RENTAL	RECORD
LOW	Administrative or operational issue without immediate safety threat. Examples: late return, service / charge issue, restricted parking or boundary correction.	Verify facts, contact renter, correct or assist, document.	Counter; supervisor if unresolved or repeated.	Continues when corrected unless another control requires escalation.	Customer / rental file; incident only if facts expand.
MEDIUM	Unsafe behavior or policy violation requiring immediate correction. Examples: standing passenger, phone use while moving, child on driver lap.	Direct safe stop or correction. Preserve distance. Re-contact if needed.	Field/counter + supervisor for repeat, refusal, or uncertainty.	May continue after verified correction; repeated or escalating conduct may end rental.	Observation / incident record based on severity and recurrence.
HIGH	Immediate danger, serious safety violation, suspected impairment, child driving, reckless driving, or public danger.	Do not approach unsafely. Direct stop when contact is safe. Disengage, terminate through authority, call 911 when danger is immediate.	Supervisor / owner; emergency services when threshold is met.	Ends when termination is confirmed or emergency control requires it.	Incident Record + preserved supporting evidence.

CLASSIFICATION RULE

Classify by the condition actually observed and the immediacy of risk. Do not raise or lower the classification because a customer is pleasant, angry, known to staff, or arguing about the rule.

A condition may move upward as facts change. When a low or medium issue becomes an immediate danger, the current risk controls the response.

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Field response - four steps

Confirm. Contact. Disengage or escalate. Document.

01

CONFIRM

CONFIRM

Confirm the asset belongs to the fleet and the rental is active. Use the asset identifier, reservation record, approved location data, staff observation, or reliable witness information. No enforcement action occurs without confirmation.

02

CONTACT

CONTACT

Contact the renter by phone, text, approved electronic message, or in person only when on-site and safe. State the verified condition and the required correction. Keep tone factual and brief.

03DISENGAGE
ESCALATE**DISENGAGE / ESCALATE**

If the renter refuses, does not respond, or the situation is unsafe, do not pursue or physically intervene. Escalate according to risk classification. High-risk immediate danger may require 911.

04

DOCUMENT

DOCUMENT

Record asset ID, date/time, location, condition observed, how it was confirmed, contact attempts, response, staff involved, screenshots/photos if permitted, and the final disposition.

CONTACT SCRIPT

"Hi, this is [Name] from [Company]. We have confirmed that the rental asset associated with your reservation is involved in [verified condition]. For safety and compliance, please [required action] now. If you need assistance, tell me your current location and I will route the appropriate response."

FIELD BOUNDARY

The purpose of field response is to restore control or move the matter to the authority that can. It is not to win an argument, make an accusation, or physically compel compliance.

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Low-risk procedures

Administrative control with a documented close or a clear escalation.

LATE RETURN

SITUATION	Scheduled return time has passed or the asset is overdue under the signed agreement.
ACTION	Confirm the reservation and scheduled return. Contact the renter. Record delay and response. Apply only a disclosed late-return control supported by the agreement.
SCRIPT	<i>"Your rental is beyond the scheduled return time. I am confirming the return plan and the terms in your agreement. Please tell me your current location and expected return time."</i>
RECORD	Customer file: scheduled time, actual/contact time, response, return outcome, and any disclosed charge applied.
CLOSE OR ESCALATE	Close when returned and documented. Escalate to supervisor if unresponsive, materially overdue, unsafe, or recovery may be required.

FUEL / CHARGE ASSISTANCE

SITUATION	The renter requests or requires fuel/charging assistance or a service call without another immediate danger.
ACTION	Confirm location and asset. Give safe stop instructions if needed. Route assistance. Do not promise a fee amount from memory.
SCRIPT	<i>"Stay in a safe location and do not attempt an unauthorized repair. I am confirming the service response and the terms that apply to your reservation."</i>
RECORD	Customer file: time, location, reason, assistance provided, staff/travel involved, and any disclosed service charge.
CLOSE OR ESCALATE	Close after service and record completion. Escalate if mechanical failure, abandonment, unsafe location, or dispute develops.

RESTRICTED PARKING / ZONE

SITUATION	The asset is verified in a restricted parking area or outside an approved operating boundary without immediate public danger.
ACTION	Confirm asset and active rental. Contact renter and request immediate correction. Do not pursue.
SCRIPT	<i>"We have confirmed the rental asset is in a restricted area. Please move it to the approved zone now and let us know when that is complete."</i>
RECORD	Customer file or observation note: confirmation method, location, contact, correction, recurrence.
CLOSE OR ESCALATE	Close when corrected. Escalate repeated refusal or any condition that becomes unsafe or unlawful.

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Medium-risk procedures

Unsafe behavior requires immediate correction and controlled follow-through.

STANDING PASSENGER

SITUATION	A passenger is standing while the vehicle is moving or being operated in a manner inconsistent with seating requirements.
ACTION	Instruct the renter to stop safely and seat all passengers. Confirm correction before continued operation when possible.
SCRIPT	<i>"Please stop safely. All passengers must remain properly seated before the rental continues."</i>
RECORD	Observation / incident note: asset, time, source, contact, correction, recurrence.
CLOSE OR ESCALATE	Continue after correction if policy allows and no other risk exists. Escalate repeat or refusal to supervisor and possible termination.

PHONE USE WHILE DRIVING

SITUATION	Driver is observed using a handheld phone while the vehicle is moving, creating an unsafe operation concern.
ACTION	Direct the renter to stop using the device while moving and operate only when attention can remain on the vehicle and surroundings.
SCRIPT	<i>"For safety, do not use the phone while the vehicle is moving. Please stop safely if you need to use the device."</i>
RECORD	Observation note with source, contact, response, and repeat behavior.
CLOSE OR ESCALATE	Close after correction. Escalate repeated behavior, refusal, or dangerous driving classification.

CHILD ON DRIVER LAP

SITUATION	A child is positioned on the driver while the vehicle is moving or ready to move.
ACTION	Direct an immediate safe stop and proper seating before operation continues.
SCRIPT	<i>"Stop safely now. The child cannot ride on the driver. Everyone must be properly seated before the rental continues."</i>
RECORD	Observation / incident note including correction and any repeat conduct.
CLOSE OR ESCALATE	Continue only after safe correction and if permitted by policy. Repeat or refusal escalates to supervisor and possible termination.

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High-risk procedures

Immediate danger ends routine service and moves the matter to authority.

SUSPECTED IMPAIRMENT

SITUATION	Observable facts create a serious concern that the driver may be impaired while operating or attempting to operate. Staff do not diagnose intoxication.
ACTION	Do not approach unsafely. Direct the renter to stop if contact can be made safely. Notify supervisor. Terminate under authority. Call 911 when active operation creates immediate danger.
SCRIPT	<i>"We cannot continue the rental because of an immediate safety concern. Stop operating the vehicle and follow the safe return or recovery instructions we provide."</i>
RECORD	Incident Record with observable facts, time, location, confirmation source, contact attempts, management, and police reference if any.
CLOSE OR ESCALATE	Termination and controlled recovery. Emergency services when active danger exists. No counter debate about impairment.

CHILD DRIVING

SITUATION	A child or other ineligible person is operating the asset.
ACTION	Direct immediate safe stop. Notify supervisor. Terminate the rental. Do not physically intervene. Call 911 if operation creates immediate danger.
SCRIPT	<i>"This is a critical safety violation. Stop the vehicle safely now. The rental is being terminated and the supervisor will direct the next step."</i>
RECORD	Incident Record + supporting observation / screenshot / witness information.
CLOSE OR ESCALATE	Termination. Escalate to law enforcement when immediate danger, refusal, or child safety requires it.

RECKLESS DRIVING / PUBLIC DANGER

SITUATION	Confirmed operation creates immediate danger through reckless conduct, dangerous speed, collision risk, or similar public hazard.
ACTION	Disengage from unsafe proximity. Notify supervisor. Terminate. Call 911 for active immediate danger or injury.
SCRIPT	<i>"The rental is terminated because of an immediate safety violation. Stop operating the vehicle safely. Emergency services may be contacted if the danger continues."</i>
RECORD	Incident Record, preserved evidence, witness information, law-enforcement reference, management action.
CLOSE OR ESCALATE	Emergency response and termination. Recovery occurs only when safe and authorized.

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Law enforcement

Know the threshold, make the call, preserve the facts.

911 - IMMEDIATE EMERGENCY

- Injury or medical emergency requiring urgent assistance.
- Active dangerous or reckless driving creating immediate risk to people or the public.
- Suspected impaired driving that is active and dangerous.
- Violence, credible threat, weapon concern, or assault.
- Theft in progress, hit-and-run with immediate danger, or a child/person in immediate danger.
- Any other condition where delaying emergency response could materially increase harm.

NON-EMERGENCY LAW-ENFORCEMENT CONTACT

- Unreturned asset after reasonable company contact when no immediate danger is known.
- Past significant damage, vandalism, or suspected theft requiring an official report.
- Repeated unlawful operation that is not currently an emergency.
- Non-urgent refusal to leave, trespass, false information, or dispute when official assistance/reporting is appropriate.
- Other owner/supervisor-directed report that does not meet the 911 threshold.

WHAT THE CALLER GIVES

- Company name and caller name / role.
- Exact current location and safest access point.
- Type of incident and whether it is active or already ended.
- Rental asset type and unit identifier.
- Immediate risk, injuries, threats, direction of travel, or description needed to locate the situation.
- What has been confirmed versus what is only reported by a witness.

STAFF BOUNDARY

Staff do not chase, touch, block the asset, enter a dangerous confrontation, exaggerate facts, speculate about criminal guilt, admit company fault, or post incident details publicly. Follow official instructions once emergency personnel take control.

After action: complete the Incident Record; preserve photos, video, GPS screenshots, witness information, and official reference numbers; notify management; file the record before shift end unless emergency conditions prevent it.

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Mechanical interruption

Stop safely. Ask facts. Replace only through authority. Decide negligence later.

PROCEDURE CONTROL

PURPOSE	OWNER	WHEN
Control a breakdown or equipment concern without turning a roadside response into a fault accusation.	Field responder + supervisor	Whenever a renter reports or staff observes a mechanical concern, loss of operation, warning condition, or possible damage.

STEPS IN ORDER	
01	Instruct the renter to stop in a safe location and discontinue operation when continued use may increase danger or damage.
02	Ask first: Is anyone injured? Is the location safe? What happened immediately before the issue? Did any warning appear? Was there impact, water, overload, or another unusual event? Is the asset currently movable?
03	If injury or immediate danger exists, use emergency response first. Do not make repair or recovery the priority over people.
04	Prevent unauthorized repair, tampering, or continued driving until the response is decided.
05	Document the condition, location, time, asset, renter statement, and visible evidence. Route the asset to Fleet control as required.
06	A replacement may be offered only when fleet availability permits and a supervisor/owner with replacement authority approves it.
07	When an asset changes, record the old unit, replacement unit, exact time, authorizing person, and customer acknowledgment required by the Pickup & Return / customer file process.
08	Negligence, chargeability, refund, and fault are management decisions made after evidence review. Counter or field staff do not accuse the renter at roadside.

PROFESSIONAL RESPONSE MODEL

"Thank you for letting us know. Stop in a safe location and do not attempt a repair. We are documenting the condition and will determine the safe next step. Any decision about replacement, damage, or responsibility is made after the evidence is reviewed."

RECORD CREATED	IF THIS FAILS / ESCALATE TO
Customer file + Pickup & Return asset-change entry + Incident Record when damage, accident, injury, suspected misuse, or material dispute exists.	Supervisor / owner for replacement, disputed cause, suspected misuse, charge review, or unavailable replacement. 911 for injury or immediate danger.

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Hostile or refusing customer

Calm posture. Written policy. Supervisor. No argument.

OPERATING SEQUENCE

- Keep physical space and a calm tone. Do not mirror volume, threats, insults, or emotion.
- Listen long enough to identify the issue. Move immediately to the written agreement, approved policy, or transaction record.
- State what you can do within your authority. Do not promise refunds, waive charges, or admit fault to end the conversation.
- If the customer remains hostile, refuses a required payment step, or demands an unauthorized exception, suspend further discretionary service and bring in the supervisor.
- If the customer refuses to leave after a lawful request, threatens anyone, blocks operations, damages property, or creates an immediate safety concern, use law-enforcement escalation at the appropriate emergency level.
- Record the material facts and the final outcome. Do not create an emotional narrative in the file.

PROFESSIONAL RESPONSE MODEL

"I have explained the policy that applies to this transaction. I am not authorized to change that term. A supervisor can review the record with you. If we cannot continue the interaction safely, we will suspend service and use the next escalation step."

PAYMENT REFUSAL

When a required payment or signed authorization is refused, do not release additional service, replacement equipment, or another discretionary benefit that depends on that payment step. Preserve the existing transaction record and escalate the dispute. Never invent a charge or use physical control to collect payment.

WHAT STAFF NEVER DO

- Chase or touch the customer.
- Block a moving vehicle or attempt a physical repossession in an unsafe setting.
- Argue, insult, threaten, or post about the customer.
- Admit company fault or promise legal/insurance outcomes.
- Invent a policy, charge, refund, deadline, or consequence to force compliance.

ESCALATION

Supervisor / owner for ongoing dispute. Law enforcement when there is a threat, refusal to leave, active damage, theft, violence, or another condition meeting the emergency / non-emergency threshold.

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Operational charges

The SOP controls the application process - never the amount.

CHARGE RULE

No amount is set in this standard. Apply only a charge disclosed in the current Agreement Control Register and signed customer agreement, and only when the required supporting record exists.

EVENT	EVIDENCE BEFORE APPLICATION	OPERATING ACTION	AUTHORITY / ESCALATION
Late return	Scheduled return + actual return/contact record + signed term.	Calculate only under the disclosed method; attach support to customer file.	Routine processing within delegated authority; dispute to supervisor.
Service call / fuel / charge	Reason for call, time, location, response provided, signed/disclosed term.	Record service delivered and supporting travel/assistance facts.	Supervisor if cause or charge is disputed.
Excessive cleaning	Return inspection, photos when appropriate, condition beyond ordinary turnover, disclosed term.	Document condition before restoration; preserve evidence.	Supervisor / owner for material charge.
Damage / missing item	Pickup & Return comparison, photos, incident/damage record, repair/replacement evidence, disclosed term.	Do not estimate fault at counter. Route to documented review.	Management decision before final charge when material or disputed.

APPLICATION SEQUENCE

- Confirm the event and the controlling signed agreement.
- Confirm the charge exists in the current approved charge structure.
- Collect the required evidence before processing the charge.
- Apply only within the employee's delegated authority.
- Provide the supporting information required by policy / payment rules.
- Escalate disputed, damage-related, or materially uncertain charges to management.
- File the evidence and transaction result with the customer record.

A charge is not an enforcement tool. It is a documented transaction outcome authorized by the signed agreement and the approved control structure.

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Records and end-of-shift filing

If it is material, it is named, filed, and retrievable before the shift ends.

WHERE EACH RECORD LIVES

LOCATION	FILE BEFORE SHIFT END
Customer / reservation file	Reservation record; Customer Execution Packet; required identity/insurance evidence; Pickup & Return reference; routine customer communication; return record; transaction/charge support; approved asset-change entry.
Incident file	Incident Record; photos; permitted video; GPS/telematics screenshot; witness information; law-enforcement reference; management instructions; damage/claim support; final disposition when available.
Employee file	Employee Acknowledgment; training confirmation; role authorization; performance/discipline documents when applicable. Customer incident records do not belong here unless the document is specifically employee-related.
Office / control records	Key counts, closing evidence, controlled-document versions, access records, and retention/destruction evidence under the Office Operations Standard.

MINIMUM INCIDENT FACTS

- Asset ID and reservation reference.
- Date, time, and location.
- Condition observed and source of confirmation.
- Customer contact attempts and exact operating instruction given.
- Staff involved and supervisor / owner notified.
- Photos, screenshots, witnesses, or official reference numbers when applicable.
- Outcome: corrected, continued, terminated, recovered, replaced, police involved, open for review, or closed.

RETENTION CONTROL

This SOP does not set retention periods. Retention, access, destruction, privacy, and document-security rules are controlled by the Office Operations Standard and applicable business requirements.

Open matters that cannot be fully completed before shift end must be named, assigned to an accountable owner, and handed off with the current record. "Follow up tomorrow" is not a record.

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Training gate and controlled deviation

No field assignment before acknowledgment. No invisible version of the procedure.

TRAINING GATE

No employee is assigned to field response until the required training has been completed and the Employee Acknowledgment is signed and filed. The signature remains in the employee file and is not reproduced in this guide.

CONTROL	STANDARD
Who verifies	Supervisor / manager verifies the training gate before the employee's first field assignment.
What is verified	Current SOP review, role authority, risk classification, field response, emergency thresholds, and supporting document locations.
Where evidence lives	Employee file. The acknowledgment form is separate from this SOP.
If not complete	No independent field assignment. Employee remains within the scope of authorized supervised duties.

VERSION AND DEVIATION

- Only the owner or the owner's documented authority may approve a permanent change to this standard.
- A verbal instruction may direct an immediate safe response, but it does not become a new procedure merely because it was spoken.
- Any temporary exception that changes the standard must be written, dated, name the approving owner/authority, state its scope, and be reviewed for incorporation or withdrawal.
- Obsolete versions must be removed from active use so staff are not choosing between competing procedures.
- Material incidents, law/regulation changes, insurer direction, operating changes, or repeated deviations trigger an early review before the scheduled next review date.

CLOSING NOTICE

This is an experience-based operating standard designed to support consistent rental operations and risk response. It is not legal advice, an insurance policy, a law-enforcement directive, or a substitute for applicable law, emergency services, insurer requirements, or qualified counsel. The operating business remains responsible for adapting and approving the standard for its own activities, location, equipment, and authority structure.

Build the function. Protect the standard. Create the legacy.

THE WE METHOD